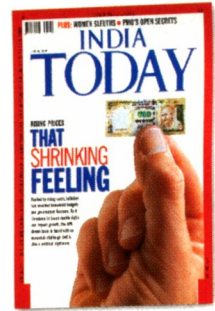


ANINDITO MUKHERJEE



"That Shrinking Feeling",
June 30, 2008

"To combat inflation, the Government must allow the rupee to appreciate, abolish import duty on edible oil and plug the leakages in public distribution system."

J. AKSHOBHYA, *Mysore*

Inflated Troubles

Though nobody has a magic wand to control inflation, the UPA had since long ignored the signs of an impending price rise ("That Shrinking Feeling", June 30). The steps it is taking now are just knee-jerk reactions. And the double-digit inflation has negated all the good work it did over the past four years.

D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

It is indeed a quirk of fate that the dream team of economists—Manmohan Singh, P. Chidambaram and Montek Singh Ahluwalia—which salvaged the country from near bankruptcy in 1991, is today facing flak for presiding over an economy which is witnessing inflation at an all-time high.

NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN,
Thiruvananthapuram

Your well-timed and thought-provoking cover

story on the current phase of inflation has enthused our ignited minds to dwell in the past, during which goods were affordable.

VIJAY DANDIWALA, *on e-mail*

Saying that inflation cannot be checked until the prices of petrol go down is a lame excuse on the part of the finance minister. The Government must first try to plug in the leakages in the system in the form of corruption, excessive consumption, among others, and then think of raising prices of essential commodities.

J. N. BHARTIYA, *Hyderabad*

Crude prices may have shot up from \$30 to \$140 per barrel but, as pointed out in the story, the electorate is not looking for any rational explanation. It merely wants a solution to the rising prices.

A. JACOB SAHAYAM,
Thiruvananthapuram

We must take the hike in petrol prices in a positive light. This hike is sure to end the UPA's rule and is a sign of good things to come.

MAHESH KUMAR, *Delhi*

Instead of blaming the Government for inflation, we must understand that the roots of all our problems lie in the dishonesty and rampant corruption in our system. Our progress will be meaningful only when the sycophancy levels of those in power come down and they turn honest.

S. BALAKRISHNAN,
on e-mail

Nuclear Friction

Prakash Karat's stubbornness is an outcome of the anti-American doctrine deeply entrenched in his mind ("No Clear Deal", June 30). He should understand that spiralling fuel prices and increasing demands of a developing nation make it imperative

for us to explore the nuclear energy option.

I.S. DUBE, *Varanasi*

The reluctance of the Left over the nuclear deal is unfortunate. Their leanings towards China are well known. But if they analyse the situation, they would know that the US is any day a better option than China, which has never been too happy with India's development as a world power.

VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI,
Dehradun

Despite the spiralling prices, China's stooge in India, the Left, has done its best to put a spanner on the nuclear deal, which would have done us a lot of good. Yet the Government continues to appease it.

SHANMUGAM MUDALIAR,
Pune

The story failed to mention the ongoing farcical negotiations of the UPA with the